

Abhishek Gupta

TECHNICAL LEAD · BACKEND-FOCUSED FULL STACK · MICROSOFT XBOX · IIT-KANPUR

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SUMMARY

Backend-Focused Full-Stack Engineer with **6+ years at Microsoft (Xbox)**, building Azure distributed systems for **7M+ players** at 5K RPS on 99.99% SLO. Designs event-driven pipelines, NoSQL data models and cached read paths. Leads a 4-engineer team, interviews Xbox hires, and ships commerce platforms driving **\$20M+ in annual revenue**.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Backend, Architecture & APIs: Distributed Systems, System Design, Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, REST APIs, Message Queues, Data Modeling, Partitioning, Caching, Idempotency, Scalability & Performance

Cloud & Data: Azure, Cosmos DB (NoSQL), SQL Server, Redis, Service Bus, Event Hubs, AKS (Kubernetes), Docker

Languages & Frameworks: C#, .NET Core, ASP.NET Core, SQL, Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, Node.js, React

Reliability & DevOps: SLO/SLA, Observability, Live-Site & On-Call, Incident Management, CI/CD (Azure DevOps), Terraform (IaC), Unit & Integration Testing

Security & Identity: OAuth 2.0, RBAC, JIT Access, Managed Identity, Service-to-Service Auth, CVE Remediation

AI Engineering: AI Agents & Agentic Development, MCP, Tool Calling, Embeddings & RAG, Vector Search

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Microsoft, Xbox Services · *Software Engineer II (Technical Lead)*

Sep 2022 – Present

Player Engagement & Publisher News Feed Platform

- Owned and shipped a news feed platform replacing 20+ legacy systems, from design and architecture review through production delivery. Led 4 engineers across 5 partner orgs to ingest content from 600+ publishers and serve 7M+ players across every Xbox storefront at **5K RPS and 99.99%** availability; built Redis-backed read paths and 15 REST APIs.
- Cut **p99 read latency 4x (600→150 ms)** and gateway load 87% on the live game-events service by moving legacy dependencies to Cosmos DB on a redesigned partition-key and caching strategy, with zero-downtime cutovers.

AI-Powered Content Certification Platform

- Cut **~1.7 hours of manual review per title to seconds** across 150+ titles daily by designing the four-stage event-driven engine: idempotent Service Bus consumers, retry/back-off and dead-letter queues, and a store-policy rule engine.
- Owned the AI detection layer, moderating game text, images and video via Azure Content Moderation and Cognitive Services to cut false positives **12%**, plus copycat detection on the top 1,000 games via Azure AI Search embeddings.

Internal Developer Productivity Platform

- Created and led a shared debugging/ops platform, driving adoption to **130+ developers across 10+ services**.
- Built the platform's 20+ tools (S2S tokens, gateway proxy, Cosmos and SQL explorers, AKS management, diagram editor), collapsing daily debugging from **20–30 minutes to seconds** with RBAC and JIT access.

Platform Security, Identity & Reliability

- Replaced shared-key auth with a Managed-Identity-for-cache Terraform module, adopted team-wide on Redis.
- Remediated **200+** component-governance findings and High/Medium-severity CVEs across UI applications, and unblocked 30+ CI/CD pipeline and deployment failures on quarterly on-call supporting a 600+ microservice estate.

Microsoft, Xbox Services · *Software Engineer*

Jun 2020 – Sep 2022

- Pricing & Sales Campaign Authoring Platform:** Built and owned the React sales-authoring application and backend APIs for offer modeling, percent-off discounts and flexible sales campaigns, driving a **\$5M quarterly revenue increase**.
- Publisher Portal Monorepo & Game Metadata Publishing:** Owned the metadata ingestion platform from React UI to .NET via a pluggable processor model, powering **150+ daily game publishes** across every Xbox storefront; and spearheaded its decoupled UI deployment on Azure with Partner Center CI/CD, adopted org-wide across 12 products.

PROJECTS

- NexusHub: AI Agents & Skills Orchestration Dashboard** | *Express, Copilot CLI & React* | *Xbox Hackathon Winner 2026*

ACHIEVEMENTS & LEADERSHIP

- Microsoft Impact Awards:** Leadership recognition for two flagship commerce launches.
- Cultural V-Team Champion, Xbox IDC (140+ members):** Led org-wide culture events and tournaments for six years.
- GATE 2018:** AIR 323 (top 0.3%) | **Academic Excellence Award**, IIT Kanpur | **TCS CodeVita 2017:** AIR 145 of 99,473

EDUCATION

Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Kanpur · *M.Tech, Computer Science*

2018 – 2020 | **9.7 CGPA**

Institute of Engineering & Technology (IET), Lucknow · *B.Tech, Computer Science*

2014 – 2018 | **82%**